Global Leave Policy (Version 1)

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Applies to	All offices
Owner	People Team
Classification	Internal

1. Purpose

This policy sets out the types of leave available to employees of Veltrix Systems, how much leave employees receive, and how leave is requested and recorded. It aims to give employees time to rest, recover and care for others, while allowing teams to plan their work.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all permanent employees of Veltrix Systems in every office. Where a regional addendum exists for an office, the addendum describes the local rules that apply in that office in addition to, or instead of, the rules below. Contractors and interns are covered by their contracts.

3. Definitions

- Leave year: the calendar year, from 1 January to 31 December.
- Working day: a day from Monday to Friday that is not a public holiday in the employee's office.
- Line manager: the person the employee reports to in the HR system.
- Primary caregiver: the parent who has the main responsibility for caring for a child after birth or adoption.
- Secondary caregiver: a parent who is not the primary caregiver.

4. Annual leave

Employees earn annual leave each month according to the Annual Leave Accrual Schedule. Annual leave is paid at the employee's normal rate of pay. Employees are encouraged to take at least ten working days of annual leave in each leave year, including one continuous break of at least five working days.

Annual leave must be requested in the HR system and approved by the line manager before it is taken. Requests for five or more working days should be made at least two weeks in advance.

5. Carrying annual leave forward

Employees may carry forward up to 10 days of unused annual leave into the next leave year. Carried forward days must be used by 30 June of the new leave year; any carried forward days not used by that date are forfeited. Unused annual leave above the carry-forward limit is forfeited on 31 December.

6. Sick leave

Employees receive 10 working days of paid sick leave in each leave year. Sick leave is credited in full on 1 January, or on the joining date for employees who join during the year, pro-rated by month.

Employees must tell their line manager as early as possible on the first day of absence. A medical certificate is required for any absence of more than 2 consecutive working days. Unused sick leave cannot be carried forward and is not paid out.

7. Parental leave

A primary caregiver may take up to 16 weeks of paid parental leave following the birth or adoption of a child. A secondary caregiver may take up to 2 weeks of paid parental leave, which must be taken within six months of the birth or adoption. Parental leave should be requested at least eight weeks before it starts.

8. Bereavement leave

Employees may take up to 3 working days of paid bereavement leave on the death of an immediate family member. Immediate family means a spouse or partner, child, parent, sibling, grandparent or grandchild, including step and in-law relationships.

9. Other absences

Absences for jury service, military reserve duty or other legal obligations follow local law. Unpaid leave of up to 20 working days per year may be granted at the line manager's discretion, after paid annual leave has been used.

10. Recording leave

All leave must be recorded in the HR system. Leave is counted in working days; weekends and public holidays that fall within a period of leave are not deducted from the employee's balance. Leave is taken in whole days.

11. Review

The People Team reviews this policy every year. Questions about this policy should be sent to hr@veltrix.example.